

Chapter 3, Section 3

James Lee

October 9, 2026

1. Let X be a Noetherian scheme. Show that X is affine if and only if X_{red} (II, Ex. 2.3) is affine.

Proof. One direction is clear. Suppose $X_{\text{red}} = \text{Spec } A$ where A is a Noetherian ring with no nilpotent elements, let $f : X_{\text{red}} \rightarrow X$ be the natural map, and let $\mathcal{F}$ be any quasi-coherent sheaf on X . Following the hint, consider the filtration

$$\mathcal{F} \supseteq \mathcal{N} \cdot \mathcal{F} \supseteq \mathcal{N}^2 \cdot \mathcal{F} \supseteq \cdots,$$

where $\mathcal{N}$ is the sheaf of nilpotent elements on X . Note that $X \cong X_{\text{red}}$ as topological space, and the associated morphism of sheaves $\mathcal{O}_X \rightarrow f_* \mathcal{O}_{X_{\text{red}}}$ is surjective with kernel $\mathcal{N}$. Thus, each of the quotients of this filtration can be naturally viewed as A -modules. In particular, we have a natural isomorphism (2.10)

$$H^i(X, \mathcal{N}^r \cdot \mathcal{F} / \mathcal{N}^{r+1} \mathcal{F}) \cong H^i(X_{\text{red}}, f^*(\mathcal{N}^r \cdot \mathcal{F} / \mathcal{N}^{r+1} \cdot \mathcal{F})).$$

Also, the nilradical of a Noetherian ring is nilpotent, so there exists a positive integer $r > 0$ such that $\mathcal{N}^r = 0$ (A.M. 7.15). Using our hypothesis and (3.7), we climb up the filtration and deduce that $H^1(X, \mathcal{F}) = 0$. Hence, X is affine by (3.7). $\square$

2. Let X be a reduced Noetherian scheme. Show that X is affine if and only if each irreducible component is affine.

Proof. Suppose $X = \text{Spec } A$ is affine for some reduced Noetherian ring A . The irreducible components of X correspond to the minimal prime ideals $\mathfrak{p}$ of A (A.M. Ex. 1.20). In particular, the irreducible components of X are precisely $\text{Spec } A/\mathfrak{p}$. Conversely, let X_i be the irreducible components of X , and let $\phi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \bigoplus_i j_{*} \mathcal{F}|_{X_i}$ be the natural map of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules, where $j : X_i \hookrightarrow X$ is the inclusion. Since X is Noetherian, $X_i \cap X_j$ is quasi-compact, so we can cover it with a finite number of open affine subsets X_{ijk} . Because X is reduced, ϕ is injective, so we can extend ϕ by the following exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{F} \longrightarrow \bigoplus_i j_{*} \mathcal{F}|_{X_i} \longrightarrow \bigoplus_{i,j} j_{*} \mathcal{F}|_{X_{ijk}}.$$

Each $j_{*} \mathcal{F}|_{X_i}, j_{*} \mathcal{F}|_{X_{ijk}}$ has vanishing cohomology for $i > 0$ by (2.10), (3.5), and (3.7). While the sequence above is not surjective on the right, the image is still a quasi-coherent sheaf, so using the long exact sequence of cohomology, we deduce that $H^i(X, \mathcal{F}) = 0$ for $i > 0$. Hence, X is affine by (3.7). $\square$

6. Let X be a Noetherian scheme.

- (a) Show that the sheaf $\mathcal{G}$ constructed in the proof of (3.6) is an injective object in the category $\mathbf{Qco}(X)$ of quasi-coherent sheaves on X . Thus, $\mathbf{Qco}(X)$ has enough injectives.
- (b) Show that any injective object of $\mathbf{Qco}(X)$ is flasque.
- (c) Conclude that one can compute cohomology as the derived functors of $\Gamma(X, \cdot)$, considered as a functor $\mathbf{Qco}(X)$ to $\mathbf{Ab}$.

Proof.

- (a) The Hom functor commutes with finite direct sums in the second argument, so we can assume $\mathcal{G} = j_* \tilde{I}$, where $j : U = \text{Spec } A \rightarrow X$ is the inclusion, and I is an injective A -module. Suppose $\mathcal{N} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}$ is an injective map of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules, and we are given any $f : \mathcal{N} \rightarrow j_* \tilde{I}$. Since j^* is left exact when j is an open immersion, the induced map of A -modules $j^* \mathcal{N} \rightarrow j^* \mathcal{M}$ is also injective. For any such f there is an associated morphism of A -modules $g : j^* \mathcal{N} \rightarrow \tilde{I}$ by adjointness of j_* , so there exists an extension of g to $j^* \mathcal{M}$ by injectivity of $\tilde{I}$. By adjointness of j^* again, we obtain a morphism $\mathcal{M} \rightarrow j_* \tilde{I}$ that naturally extends f , which is what we wanted to show.

- (b) Essentially imitating (a) but replacing i^* with i_* and vice versa, we deduce that $\mathcal{I}|_U$ is an injective object of $\mathfrak{Qco}(U)$. Covering X with finite number of open affines $U_i = \text{Spec } A_i$, we have $\mathcal{I}|_{U_i} \cong \tilde{I}_i$ for some injective A_i -module I_i for each i by (II, 5.5). Each $\tilde{I}_i$ is flasque by (3.4), so $\mathcal{I}$ is flasque on a local basis. Hence, $\mathcal{I}$ is flasque.
- (c) Considering $\Gamma(X, \cdot)$ as a functor from $\mathfrak{Qco}(X)$ to $\mathfrak{Ab}$, we calculate its derived functors by taking injective resolutions in the category $\mathfrak{Qco}(X)$. But any injective is flasque (b), and flasques are acyclic (2.5), so this resolution gives the usual cohomology functors (1.2A).

□

7. Let A be a Noetherian ring, let $X = \text{Spec } A$, let $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq A$ be an ideal, and let $U \subseteq X$ be the open set $X - V(\mathfrak{a})$.

(a) For any A -module M , establish the following formula of Deligne:

$$\Gamma(U, \widetilde{M}) \cong \varinjlim_n \text{Hom}_A(\mathfrak{a}^n, M).$$

(b) Apply this in the case of an injective A -module I , to give another proof of (3.4).

Proof.

(a) To define a map $\phi : \varinjlim_n \text{Hom}_A(\mathfrak{a}^n, M) \rightarrow \Gamma(U, \widetilde{M})$, it suffices to define A -homomorphisms

$$\phi_n : \text{Hom}_A(\mathfrak{a}^n, M) \rightarrow \Gamma(U, \widetilde{M})$$

that respect the direct system

$$M \cong \text{Hom}_A(A, M) \xrightarrow{\mu_0} \text{Hom}_A(\mathfrak{a}, M) \xrightarrow{\mu_1} \text{Hom}_A(\mathfrak{a}^2, M) \xrightarrow{\mu_2} \cdots,$$

i.e., $\phi_n = \phi_{n+1} \circ \mu_n$ for all n . By the Noetherian hypothesis, $\mathfrak{a}$ is generated by finitely many elements, say $f_1, \dots, f_r$. Consider the localization of any $\alpha \in \text{Hom}_A(\mathfrak{a}^n, M)$ with respect to f_i for any i , that is $\alpha_i : (\mathfrak{a}^n)_{f_i} \rightarrow M_{f_i}$. Then $(\mathfrak{a}^n)_{f_i} \cong A_{f_i}$ since $f_i^n \in \mathfrak{a}^n$ and f_i is a unit in A_{f_i} (we exclude the case when f_i is nilpotent, since $A_{f_i} = 0$). Let $\phi_n(\alpha)$ be the section equal to $\alpha_i(1)$ on U_i , where U_i is the distinguished open set associated to f_i . We remark that $U = \bigcup_{i=1}^r U_i$, so this definition is well-defined, and it respects the direct system of above since the localization of the inclusion $\mathfrak{a}^n \hookrightarrow \mathfrak{a}^{n-1}$ is the identity map on A_{f_i} . Thus, to show $\phi_n(\alpha)$ is a well-defined section, it is sufficient to show $\alpha_i(1)$ and $\alpha_j(1)$ agree on $U_i \cap U_j \cong \text{Spec } A_{f_i f_j}$ for all i, j . Indeed, $\alpha(f_i^n) = \alpha_i(f_i^n)$ where we naturally view $\alpha(f_i^n)$ as an element of M_{f_i} , α_i is A_{f_i} -linear, and the restriction map $U_i \rightarrow U_i \cap U_j$ is given by $m/f_i^n \mapsto f_j^n/(f_i f_j)^n$. Thus, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \alpha_i(1)|_{U_i \cap U_j} &= \alpha_i(f_i^{-n} f_i^n)|_{U_i \cap U_j} \\ &= \frac{\alpha(f_i^n)}{f_i^n}|_{U_i \cap U_j} \\ &= \frac{f_j^n \alpha(f_i^n)}{(f_i f_j)^n} \\ &= \frac{f_i^n \alpha(f_j^n)}{(f_i f_j)^n} \\ &= \alpha_j(1)|_{U_i \cap U_j}. \end{aligned}$$

Also, each ϕ_n is injective, so the induced map $\phi : \varinjlim_n \text{Hom}_A(\mathfrak{a}^n, M) \rightarrow \Gamma(U, \widetilde{M})$ is injective. It remains to show ϕ is surjective. Let $s \in \Gamma(U, \widetilde{M})$ be any section. For each i , we can express $s|_{U_i}$ as $m_i/f_i^{n_i}$ for some $n_i > 0$ and $m_i \in M$ such that $m_i/f_i^{n_i}|_{U_i \cap U_j} = m_j/f_j^{n_j}|_{U_i \cap U_j}$, where $U_i \cap U_j = \text{Spec } A_{f_i f_j}$ for all i, j . Choose $n = n_i$ that works for all i , so we have

$$\frac{f_j^n m_i}{(f_i f_j)^n} = \frac{f_i^n m_j}{(f_i f_j)^n}.$$

We want to show there exists an A -homomorphism $\alpha : \mathfrak{a}^N \rightarrow M$ for some $N \geq n$ such that $\alpha_i(1) = f_i^{N-n} m_i / f_i^N$. Imitating the proof of (3.3), let $\mathfrak{b}_1 \subseteq \mathfrak{b}_2 \subseteq \cdots$ be the sequence of annihilators of $\cdots \subseteq \mathfrak{a}^2 \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$. Since A is Noetherian, there is an r such that $\mathfrak{b}_r = \mathfrak{b}_{r+1} = \cdots$. Define $\sigma : \mathfrak{a}^{n+r} \rightarrow M$ by sending f_i^{n+r} to $f_i^r m_i$ for all i and extending by zero. This is a well-defined homomorphism because the annihilator of f_i^{n+r} is $\mathfrak{b}_{n+r} = \mathfrak{b}_r$, and $\mathfrak{b}_r$ annihilates $f_i^r m_i$. Hence, $\phi_{n+r}(\sigma) = s$.

- (b) Let I be an injective A -module. It will be sufficient to show for any open set $U \subseteq X$, where $U = X - V(\mathfrak{a})$ for some ideal $\mathfrak{a}$ of A , that $\Gamma(X, \tilde{I}) \rightarrow \Gamma(U, \tilde{I})$ is surjective. The map $\Gamma(X, \tilde{I}) \rightarrow \Gamma(U, \tilde{I})$ is induced by the natural maps $\text{Hom}_A(A, I) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_A(\mathfrak{a}^n, I)$, which is surjective since I is injective. Hence, $\Gamma(X, I) \rightarrow \Gamma(U, I)$ is surjective.

□